

# The Washington Post

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Sunny, windy 60/44 • Tomorrow: Shower 66/39 **B6**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

FRIDAY, MARCH 21, 2025 • \$4

## Bondi's DOJ ushers in a MAGA makeover

Agency's realignment to mirror Trump's agenda breaks norms, critics say

BY JEREMY ROEBUCK,  
MARK BERMAN,  
PERRY STEIN  
AND SPENCER S. HSU

Pam Bondi vowed at her confirmation hearing this year that "politics will not play a part" in her time as attorney general.

Now she's leading a Justice Department more visibly aligned with the political agenda of the White House than any in recent history.

In less than two months, Bondi and other top department officials have wielded the law to shield President Donald Trump's allies and strike at his political foes. They have curtailed anti-corruption efforts that were sources of irritation for the president and ratcheted up immigration enforcement, while cutting national security expertise and refocusing the civil rights division on culture war fights that go beyond traditional conservative causes like religious freedom.

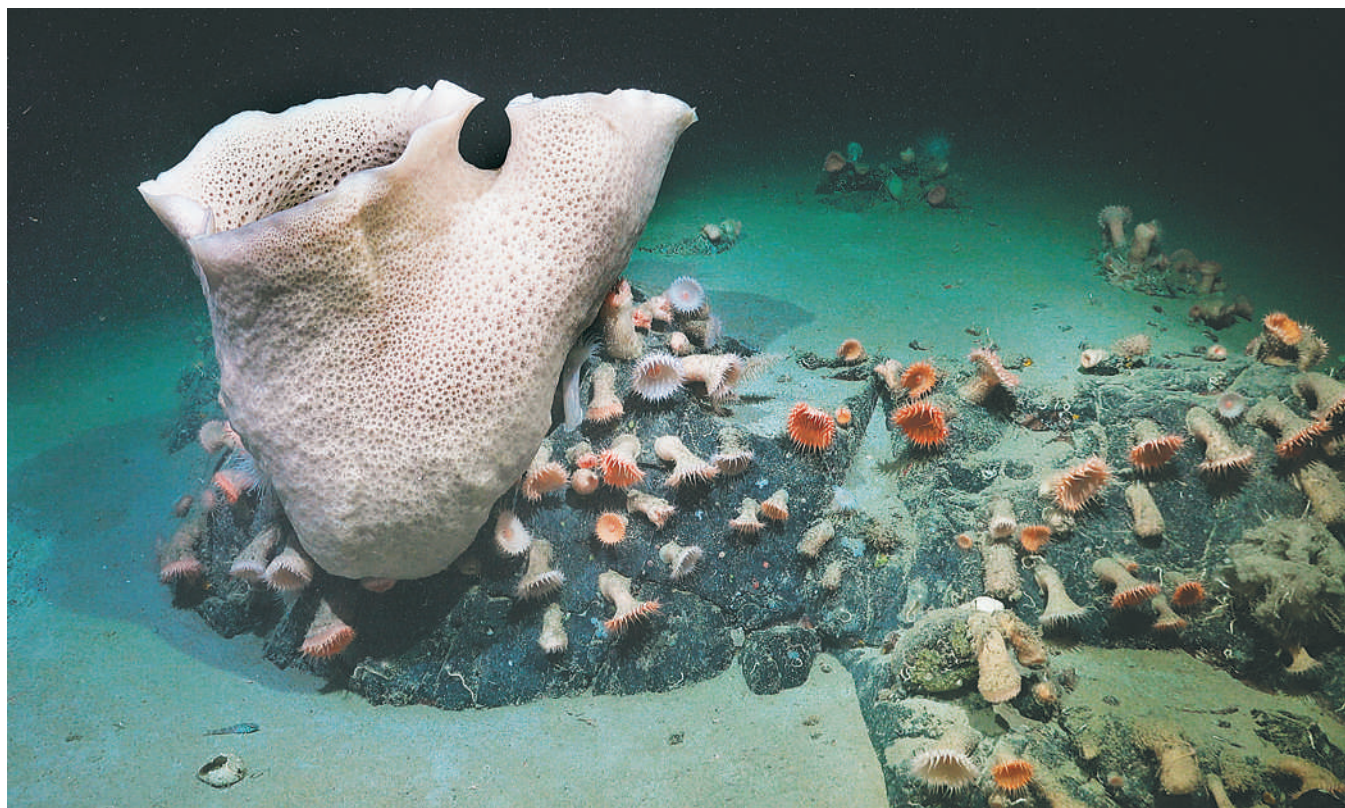
And they have pushed out dozens of prosecutors and FBI agents deemed insufficiently loyal, launching sweeping probes of past investigations and the veteran attorneys who led them.

The rapid-fire actions mirror dramatic changes underway at

SEE DOJ ON A18

**FBI:** A former agent is charged with illegally disclosing documents. **A2**

## Despite decades of darkness under Antarctic ice, life finds a way



PHOTOS BY ROV SUBASTIAN/SCHMIDT OCEAN INSTITUTE

Clockwise from top left: A stalk of deep-sea coral, a solitary hydroid and anemones clustered around a sponge are just some of the creatures researchers found during their exploration of a swath of ocean exposed when a giant iceberg cracked off an Antarctic ice sheet. **Story, A7**

## Judge stops DHS from deporting researcher

Georgetown fellow has sued to be released from immigration detention

BY DAN ROSENZWEIG-ZIFF  
AND TEO ARMUS

A federal judge on Thursday ordered that a Georgetown University fellow working in the United States legally and detained by immigration authorities cannot be removed from the country, pending the outcome of a lawsuit seeking his release from detention.

Federal judge Patricia Tolliver Giles in Virginia's Eastern District did not rule on the Trump administration's efforts to deport Indian national Badar Khan Suri, who was apprehended earlier this week for what a DHS spokesperson said was "Hamas propaganda and promoting antisemitism on social media." Suri is scheduled to appear before an immigration judge in Los Fresnos, Texas, on May 6.

Suri is the latest of a handful of scholars with legal status who have been detained in recent weeks after opposing U.S. foreign policy on Israel, inflaming outrage from critics of the Trump administration.

They argue that targeting people over their opposition to U.S. policy is a violation of the First

SEE DEPORTATION ON A6

## After a shift, Musk now fixates on anti-White bias

BY BETH REINHARD,  
FAIZ SIDDIQUI  
AND CLARA ENCE MORSE

In the spring of 2017, two months after a Black employee sued Tesla and alleged that co-workers frequently called him the n-word with impunity, chief executive Elon Musk sent out a companywide email with the subject line "Doing the right thing."

The note marked one of the first times that the billionaire tech icon, born and raised in

CEO raised in apartheid had avoided talk of race, led firm with DEI policies

privilege during South African apartheid, engaged in a public conversation about race. Avoid making offensive comments, Musk said — but don't be overly sensitive.

"Part of not being a huge jerk is

considering how someone might feel who is part of an historically less represented group," Musk wrote to thousands of employees, in a message later included in court filings in another lawsuit. But Musk added: "In fairness, if someone is a jerk to you, but sincerely apologizes, it is important to be thick-skinned and accept that apology."

Over the next eight years, as he became the richest man in the world, Musk shifted from a Democratic-leaning critic of

Donald Trump to a Republican-friendly Trump acolyte. He emerged as a hero on the far right who frequently comments on racial issues — and who wields extraordinary power overseeing the president's cost-cutting operation, known as the U.S. DOGE Service.

Musk's operatives at DOGE — which stands for Department of

SEE MUSK ON A4

**X sues:** The company accuses India of illegally blocking content. **A12**



JAHU CHIKWENDU/THE WASHINGTON POST

## Springtime blossoms in D.C.

People enjoy the warmth Thursday — the first day of spring and of the National Cherry Blossom Festival — by the Washington Monument. See the Weekend section for a guide to the festival.

## JFK files include unredacted Social Security numbers

Personal data of over 400 people made public in released documents

This article is by William Wan,  
Aaron Schaffer, Aaron Gregg,  
Clara Ence Morse and Evan Hill

The Social Security numbers and other private information of more than 400 former congressional staffers and others were made public Tuesday in the unredacted files related to the assassination of President John F. Kennedy, according to a review by The Washington Post.

"It's absolutely outrageous. It's sloppy, unprofessional," said former Trump campaign lawyer Joseph diGenova, 80.

"It not only means identity theft, but I've had threats against me," said diGenova — a fixture in Republican and Washington legal

circles who has fiercely defended President Donald Trump and has pounced on Trump's critics on cable news. "In the past, I've had to report real threats against me to the FBI. There are dangerous nuts out there."

More than 60,000 pages related to the 1963 assassination were released this week by the Trump administration. Many of the pages had been previously disclosed, but with redactions. Many, but not all, redactions have been removed. The records have been posted to the National Archives webpage under the headline "JFK Assassination Records — 2025 Documents Release."

After The Post reported the inadvertent disclosure Wednesday, The White House rushed to mitigate the impact. The National Archives started screening the documents for Social Security

SEE KENNEDY ON A8

**Martin Luther King Jr.:** Trump aims to release wiretap records. **B1**

## IN THE NEWS

**Hamas resumes strikes** Days after breaking a ceasefire, Israel killed scores of Palestinians in Gaza, and the militant group fired back for first time since fighting began again. **A12**

**Key Bridge update** The Baltimore span was at a high risk of collapse even before last year's fatal accident, the NTSB said. **B1**

**THE NATION**  
**A U.S. citizen** has been released by the Taliban after spending 2½ years in captivity. **A2**  
**The husband** of former congresswoman Cori Bush was accused of covid-era loan fraud. **A9**

**THE WORLD**  
**In dealing** with Trump, Britain's Keir Starmer has overcome a rocky start as premier. **A10**  
**Ukraine remains** skeptical that Russia will adhere to their deal for a partial ceasefire. **A11**

**THE ECONOMY**  
**Republican plans** to scrap nearly all support for electric vehicles could have long-term consequences for the industry, experts say. **A13**  
**Millions of acres** of near-pristine land in Alaska will be opened for drilling, the Interior Department said. **A14**

**THE REGION**  
**Maryland's governor** and Democratic leaders in Annapolis announced a state budget deal that includes deep cuts and new taxes. **B1**  
**Flight delays** and cancellations spiked at Reagan National Airport in the weeks after a fatal midair collision. **B1**

**STYLE**  
**At 18, Enza Anguissola** is on the cover of the DIY-oriented fashion magazine i-D, but you almost certainly don't know who she is. **C1**

**SPORTS**  
**March Madness** begins with upsets, plus some drama at Maryland, which plays today. **D1**

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